Project Report:

DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

Course:

CSE0001-DIGITAL LITERACY

(Slot: D11)

MADE BY:

SOUSTHAB MITRA

25BCE10480

SCHOOL – SCOPE

Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal, I was given the responsibility to help my batchmates navigate the digital world safely and professionally. This project is my Digital Literacy Portfolio, which demonstrates the work I completed across all five modules of CSE0001.

I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic, built my professional online profiles, explored coding and collaboration platforms, practised professional email etiquette, and researched a real cybercrime (UPI fraud) along with prevention strategies. Through this project, I learned that digital literacy is not just about using technology — it is about using it responsibly, ethically, and confidently. All my work is organised in a single GitHub repository, which will remain part of my permanent digital portfolio.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I used **Canva** to create a visually appealing one-page infographic titled **“Digital Literacy Awareness: Be Smart, Safe & Responsible Online”**. The infographic covers three important topics:

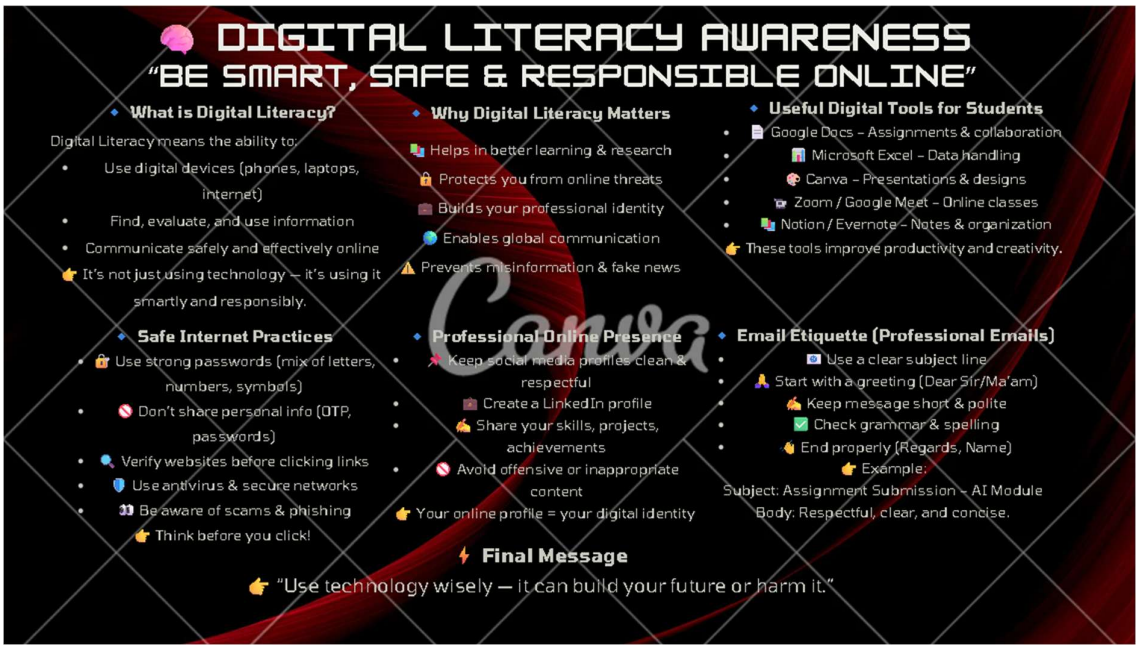
- What is Digital Literacy?

- Safe Internet Practices

- Professional Online Presence & Email Etiquette

I chose bright colours and icons to make it student-friendly. The design also includes a section on “Useful Digital Tools for Students” and ends with a powerful message.

I found Canva very easy and intuitive, but fitting all the content neatly on one page without making it look cluttered was a bit challenging. This task helped me understand the importance of visual communication in digital literacy awareness.



Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

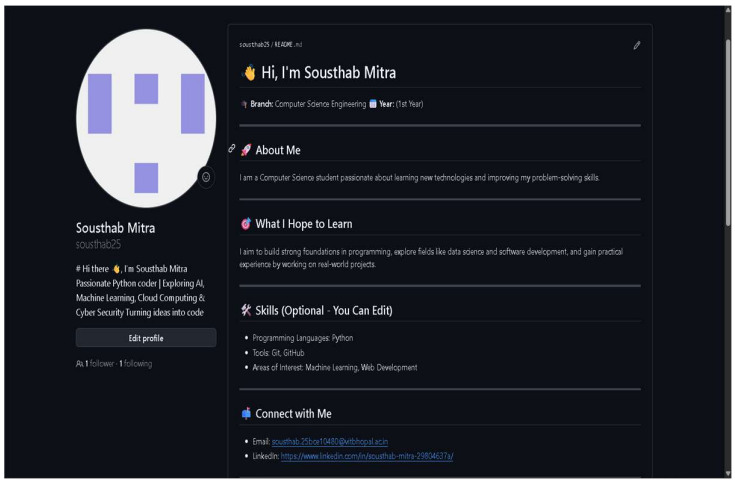
I created professional profiles on three platforms: **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**.

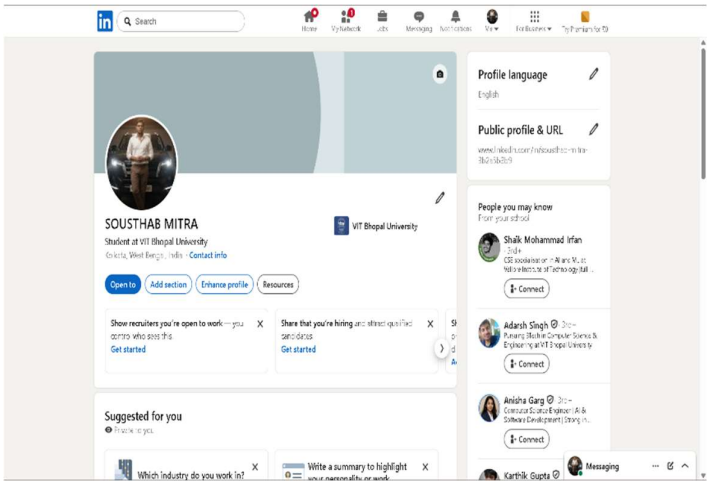
- On **GitHub**, I created a profile README repository with my name, branch, year, and a short goal statement about becoming a skilled AI/ML engineer.

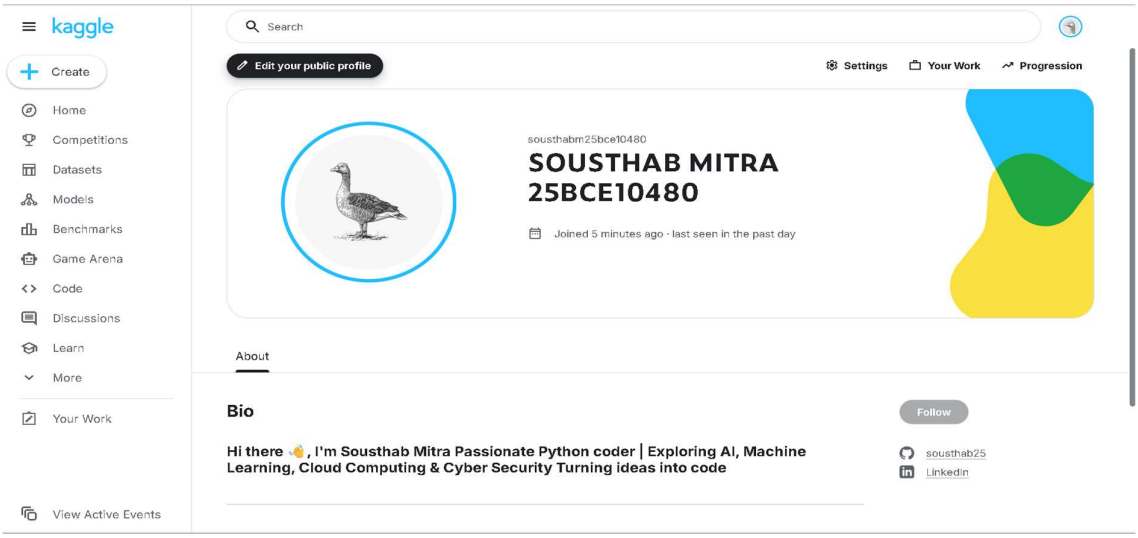
- On **LinkedIn**, I filled in my Education section with “B.Tech Computer Science Engineering, VIT Bhopal, Expected Graduation: 2029”.

- On **Kaggle**, I set up my profile to prepare for future data science and ML competitions.

These platforms serve different purposes: GitHub for showcasing projects, LinkedIn for professional networking, and Kaggle for participating in data science challenges. I plan to actively use them over the next four years for internships, placements, and building a strong digital identity.







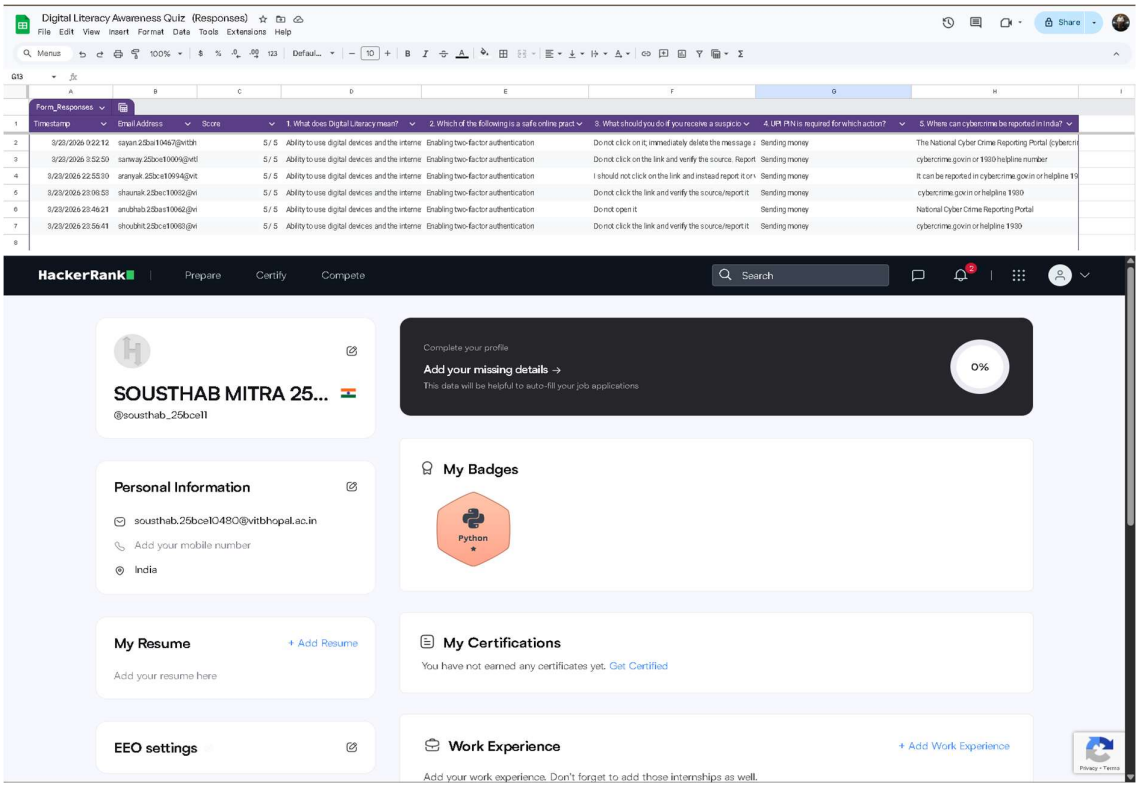
Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A (Coding Practice): I created an account on **HackerRank** and successfully completed the beginner-level “Solve Me First” challenge in Python. I received a Python badge for it.

Part B (Google Workspace – Mandatory): I created a Google Form named **“Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz”** with exactly 5 questions (including multiple-choice and short-answer types). The form is ready to be shared with my batchmates. Responses are automatically collected in a linked Google Sheet.

These tools will greatly help me academically — HackerRank for improving coding skills and Google Forms for creating surveys, quizzes, and collecting feedback from my batch.

(Screenshots of HackerRank profile/badge and Google Form + responses sheet are available in task-3-platforms/ folder)



Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

I wrote two professional emails following all standard email etiquette rules (clear subject line, polite greeting, structured body, and proper sign-off).

I also created a **Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist** with 5 Do's and 5 Don'ts for responsible social media use by college students.

One real situation I thought about was a student sending a casual "Hey sir pls extend deadline" email and getting rejected. A well-structured, respectful email would have made a huge difference. This task taught me that tone and structure matter more than the length of the email.

(Both emails and the social media checklist are saved in task-4-email-etiquette/ folder)

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

I chose **UPI / Online Payment Fraud** as my case study. I wrote a detailed 220-word case study explaining how social engineering tricks (fake payment requests, OTP sharing, screen-sharing apps) are commonly used to target college students. I also created an 8-point “Stay Safe Online” prevention checklist with special focus on UPI safety and included the official reporting channels (1930 helpline and cybercrime.gov.in).

What surprised me the most was how simple and convincing these scams are — they don’t require advanced hacking skills. As a result, I have decided to personally change my habit: I will now always verify the sender and never approve any payment request without double-checking.

(Full case study and prevention checklist are available in task-5-cybercrime/ folder)

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project has been an eye-opening experience. It helped me move from being just a user of technology to becoming a responsible and aware digital citizen. I now feel confident in guiding my batchmates on professional profiles, safe online practices, and cybercrime prevention. The skills and habits I developed through these five tasks will stay with me throughout my academic and professional journey.

Thank you, VIT Bhopal, for this wonderful opportunity.